

Should reps be able to skip Demo Date and Expected Closure Date for fast-tracked deals?

FOR Haroon Sidheeq (GM & Sales Head) and Cabio leadership

PREPARED 2026-08-04

REF docs/Discussion-FastTrack-Opportunity-Creation.md

OPEN — DECISION NEEDED

IN SHORT

Creating a deal directly at Order stage is already how the system is meant to work — that part isn't in question. What's actually being asked is narrower: **should the Demo Date and Expected Closure Date fields be skippable** for deals a rep wants to fast-track? This paper lays out what those two fields protect, what happens if they become optional, and three ways to resolve it — including one screen fix that should happen regardless of what's decided here.

1. Where this came from

During UAT smoke testing, a rep tried to create an Opportunity directly at the

During UAT smoke testing, a rep tried to create an Opportunity directly at the **Order** stage and was rejected with an error about a missing Demo Date — a field the create screen doesn't even show. Looking into it surfaced two separate questions, one already settled and one genuinely open.

Already settled

Should a rep be able to create an Opportunity directly at Order stage, instead of walking it through Lead → Qualified → Demo → Negotiation → Order one save at a time? Yes — this has been the design since an earlier decision (ADR-015): medical equipment deals often enter the pipeline mid-flight — a tender, a referral, a direct approach — so the system was always meant to allow creating a deal at any stage. The rejection the rep hit wasn't the system refusing this; it was a smaller bug where the create screen never asks for the Demo Date it needs. That fix is already scoped and doesn't need this discussion.

Still open

When fast-tracking a deal straight to Order, should Demo Date and Expected Closure Date still be required, or should they be skippable? **That's what this paper is about.**

2. What these two fields actually protect

Every Opportunity moves through stages — Lead → Qualified → Demo → Clinical Evaluation → Negotiation → Order → Delivery. At each boundary, the system asks for a small amount of information before letting the deal move further. To reach Order, that currently means: when the demo happened, and when the deal is expected to close.

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- **Trustworthy pipeline and forecast reporting.** "How long does a deal typically take from Demo to Order?" · "Which deals are closing this quarter?" · "Are we losing time in Negotiation?" — every one of these needs Demo Date and Expected Closure Date to exist on the records being analyzed. Leadership dashboards and forecasting are a committed part of where this system is going, not a hypothetical.
- **A pipeline everyone can trust the same way.** The reason Cabio Sales OS exists instead of a plain contact list is that the stages mean the same thing for every rep and every deal, so leadership can read the pipeline at face value.

3. Why "just make it optional" is bigger than it looks

- **There's no coming back to fill it in.** Once a deal is created at Order without a Demo Date, nothing in its lifecycle ever asks for it again — even if it later moves on to Delivery. Whatever's missing at creation stays missing, permanently.
- **"Fast-tracked" is easy to over-use.** If any rep can self-decide a deal qualifies, the path of least resistance is for every inconvenient deal to become "fast-tracked" — not out of bad faith, just because it's the easier box to check. Once that happens, the fields stop meaning anything for anyone, not just the deals that were genuinely exceptions.
- **No way to tell "skipped on purpose" from "forgot."** A blank Demo Date looks identical whether the deal genuinely had no formal demo, or someone rushed the form. There's currently no record of which.

4. Options

A · Fix the forms, keep both fields required

HAPPENING REGARDLESS

Add Demo Date and Expected Closure Date to the three create screens that are missing them, matching the one screen that already has them. A rep fast-tracking a deal to Order fills everything in one sitting instead of hitting an unexplained rejection.

This is a bug fix, not a policy change — it should happen whichever way the rest of this discussion lands.

B · Make both fields fully optional at Order stage

Any rep can create or advance a deal to Order with no Demo Date or Expected Closure Date recorded, no questions asked.

GETS YOU

Fastest possible entry for an already-closed or fast-moving deal.

COSTS YOU

All three risks in Section 3, in full, with no audit trail and no way to separate genuine exceptions from shortcuts.

C · Scoped, explicit, and recorded exception

RECOMMENDED

Keep both fields required by default. Add a deliberate override — restricted to a specific role such as Admin/GM, the same way cross-SBU deal creation was recently scoped — that requires a short typed reason and is permanently recorded against the deal: who overrode it, when, and why. Overridden deals stay visible as a distinct, reportable group instead of blending invisibly into normal pipeline data.

GETS YOU

COSTS YOU

The speed Haroon is asking for, on deals that genuinely warrant it — without losing the trustworthiness of the pipeline for everyone else.

More build effort than Option B — a reason field, a permission check, a small screen addition — but a pattern this codebase already uses elsewhere.

5. Comparison at a glance

QUESTION	A • FIX FORMS ONLY	B • FULLY OPTIONAL	C • SCOPED EXCEPTION
Solves the unexplained rejection?	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes
Lets a rep enter an Order-stage deal in one sitting?	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes
Demo Date / Closure Date ever skippable?	✗ Never	✗ Always	! When explicitly invoked
Risk of becoming the default for every deal	✓ None	✗ High	✓ Low
Leadership can see how often it's used	N/A — never skipped	✗ No	✓ Fully trackable
Engineering effort	Small	Small	Moderate

6. What this discussion needs to settle

Option A is happening regardless — it's a bug fix, not a decision. Leadership needs to settle the rest:

1 Should any Opportunity ever be allowed to reach Order stage without a recorded Demo Date and Expected Closure Date?

2 If yes — for which situations, specifically? (A repeat customer reordering existing equipment with no fresh demo, and a deal closed outside the system and logged after the fact, are two real examples worth naming — the answer shapes how narrow or broad the exception should be.)

3 If yes — who should be allowed to invoke it, and should a reason always be required?

4 Who reviews the exceptions afterward — e.g. a monthly look at overridden deals — so the exception doesn't quietly become the default path?

7. Reference

—docs/ADR.md — ADR-015 (Opportunity Creation at Any Sales Stage), ADR-001 (Sales Operating System positioning), ADR-013 (Target → Coverage → Opportunity → Revenue hierarchy and its reporting commitment)

—docs/Business-Rules.md — BR-OP-00 (Opportunity Creation Flexibility), BR-OP-01 (Stage Transition Exit Criteria)

—docs/Backlog.md — the related form-completion bug (Option A above)

Once a decision is reached, it should be recorded as a formal rule change in `Business-Rules.md` — and a new ADR if Option B or C is chosen — not left in this discussion paper.